

HOUSE JOINT RESOLUTION 357

By Eldridge

A RESOLUTION to recognize Kathy Jones-Terry, Hamblen County Chancery and Probate Court Clerk and Master, on the occasion of her retirement.

WHEREAS, it is appropriate that the members of this General Assembly should honor those citizens who have performed with uncommon devotion and enthusiasm throughout their years of public service; and

WHEREAS, one such estimable person is Kathy Jones-Terry, who, having admirably served the citizens of Hamblen County as Chancery and Probate Court County Clerk and Master since 1995, is taking a much-deserved retirement this year; and

WHEREAS, Ms. Jones-Terry holds a Bachelor of Arts degree in English with secondary certification in English Education from the University of Tennessee, Knoxville, and a master's degree in English literature from Vanderbilt University; she became a certified public administrator through the University of Tennessee Institute for Public Service, County Officials Certificate Training Program; and

WHEREAS, after a one-year stint as an interviewer with the Hamblen County Department of Human Services, Kathy Jones-Terry taught English and journalism at Morristown-Hamblen West High School from 1982 to 1995; and

WHEREAS, in becoming the clerk and master of the Hamblen County Chancery and Probate Court in 1995, she followed in the footsteps of her mother, Jean Wolfe Jones, who held the post for thirty years immediately prior to the start of Kathy Jones-Terry's nearly thirty-year tenure; and

WHEREAS, during her time as clerk and master, she has served three chancellors, created and maintained a clerk and master public website for court information and payment of

delinquent taxes, and transitioned her office to online delinquent tax sales as well as to e-filing and permanent digital storage of all Chancery and Probate Court records for Hamblen County; and

WHEREAS, a leader in her profession, Ms. Jones-Terry has been a member of the State Court Clerks' Association of Tennessee since 1995, serving as state treasurer (1996-2001); East Tennessee secretary, vice president, and president (2002-2005); state president-elect (2005-2006); state president (2006-2007); and state secretary (2008-2010, 2018-2019); and

WHEREAS, she brought her teaching background to the State Court Clerks' Association of Tennessee, streamlining professional education courses so clerks could learn more in a single session and forming a committee to rework the general manual for clerks; and

WHEREAS, she was also a member of the County Officials Association of Tennessee from 1995 to 2025, where she served numerous terms on the Board of Directors and on various committees, including the Charity Focus Committee, which she served as clerk (2017-2018) and chair and clerk (2019-2025); and

WHEREAS, Ms. Jones-Terry has been duly honored for her good work over the years; she was named the State Court Clerks' Association of Tennessee's Clerk of the Year in 2003, and in 2019, the County Officials Association of Tennessee named her Court Clerk of the Year; and

WHEREAS, Kathy Jones-Terry exemplifies the spirit and allegiance to family and community that are characteristic of a true Tennessean; and

WHEREAS, throughout her illustrious tenure as Hamblen County Chancery and Probate Court Clerk and Master, Ms. Jones-Terry has distinguished herself as a public-spirited citizen of the highest order, winning the respect and admiration of her colleagues and the people she has so ably served; now, therefore,

BE IT RESOLVED BY THE HOUSE OF REPRESENTATIVES OF THE ONE HUNDRED FOURTEENTH GENERAL ASSEMBLY OF THE STATE OF TENNESSEE, THE SENATE CONCURRING, that we extend to Kathy Jones-Terry, Hamblen County Chancery and Probate Court Clerk and Master, our heartfelt wishes for a happy and fulfilling retirement and every continued success in her future endeavors.

BE IT FURTHER RESOLVED, that an appropriate copy of this resolution be prepared for presentation with this final clause omitted from such copy and upon proper request made to the appropriate clerk, the language appearing immediately following the State seal appear without House or Senate designation.